

TALON-7
Assembly

Written by
Robin McManus

Copyright (c) 2025

Draft
robin@movieshaker.com

Contact
07711 731107

FADE IN:

INT. FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - MORNING

The mood in the kitchen is a tense silence. Sarah and Kade sit at the table, coffee cups in front of them. Both staring at Sarah's phone lying on the table.

No notifications.

The clock on the wall reads 8:47 AM.

Mr. Whiskers sits on the window sill, grooming himself, indifferent to the tension.

KADE

Nothing?

SARAH

Nothing.

KADE

How long has it been?

SARAH

Fourteen hours since I sent it.

Sarah hesitates, picks up her phone, checks it again, sets it back down.

SARAH (cont'd)

Maybe they thought it was a joke.

KADE

Or maybe they don't care.

SARAH

Or maybe they're smart enough NOT to respond to a cryptic message from someone they've never actually met.

Kade stands, walks towards the window, looks out at the field where Talon-7 sits exposed.

KADE

The ship. It's too visible, we have to hide it.

SARAH

You said it couldn't fly.

KADE

It has enough power for one short flight, do you think the ship will fit inside the barn?

SARAH

Probably. Why?

KADE

Prying eyes. Satellites. Drones. The longer it sits in the open, the higher the risk someone notices.

SARAH

You want to move it now?

KADE

If we wait much longer, there may not be enough power to move it.

Sarah considers this, then nods.

SARAH

Let me clear some equipment out of the barn first.

SHIP'S AI

I have located a potential charging solution.

Both Kade and Sarah turn to look at the AI device.

KADE

Charging solution?

SHIP'S AI

The barn structure contains electrical systems. Primitive but functional. With modifications, I can adapt the ship's intake coupling to accept local power grid energy. Conversion efficiency will be low but sufficient.

SARAH

You're saying you can charge an alien spaceship using the barn's electrical outlet?

SHIP'S AI

With modifications, yes.

KADE

How long?

SHIP'S AI

Full power restoration: impossible
with available resources. Adequate
combat functionality: seventy two to
ninety six hours of continuous
charging.

SARAH

Three to four days.

KADE

(calculating)

That still leaves us ten days for
training. If anyone shows up.

An uncomfortable silence.

SARAH

Let's move the ship. We deal with one
problem at a time.

INT. FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

They walk through the living room toward the door. Sarah
grabs keys from a hook.

Her phone, CHIMES.

Both freeze.

Sarah runs back, grabs the phone.

KADE

What is it?

SARAH

One of them responded. Void_Hunter.

She reads the message, frowning.

SARAH (cont'd)

He says he wants to meet, er, to make
sure I'm okay.

KADE

That's good ... isn't it?

SARAH

He also says the other two think I'm either drunk or having a nervous breakdown. he says they are not interested.

KADE

So we have one. (shrugs) That's a start.

SARAH

Maybe!

She types a quick response, hits send.

SARAH (cont'd)

I told him to come this afternoon at two o'clock.

KADE

Then we should move the ship before he arrives.

EXT. FIELD - TALON-7 - DAY

Kade and Sarah approach the ship. It looks even more battered in daylight, its hull is badly scorched with signs of visible damage, but still, undeniably advanced.

Kade opens the airlock with a palm scan.

INT. TALON-7 COCKPIT - DAY

The interior is dark, minimal power. Kade slides into the pilot seat, activates emergency systems. Displays flicker to life.

KADE

(mutters)

Power reserves at one percent. This is going to be close.

Through the cockpit window, he sees Sarah watching.

KADE (cont'd)

(into comm)

Clear the barn. I'll bring her in.

EXT. FIELD - DAY

The ship's engines WHINE to life, not the roar from before, but a struggling hum, Talon-7 lifts slowly, wobbling slightly.

Sarah watches, holding her breath.

The ship moves forward, low and careful, towards the barn.

INT. BARN - DAY

Sarah has pushed equipment aside, creating a space barely large enough for the ship.

The barn doors are wide open.

Talon-7 appears in the doorway, edging in carefully, the fit is tight, less than a meter clearance on either side.

The ship settles onto the barn floor with a heavy THUD. The engines die. Silence.

EXT. BARN - DAY

Kade emerges from the airlock.

KADE
Power reserves at one percent.

SARAH
But we made it.

KADE
Barely.

Sarah closes the barn doors.

SARAH
The AI can start working on a
charging solution. We have ...

She checks her phone.

SARAH (cont'd)
an hour before Void_Hunter arrives.

KADE
Enough time to think about what we're
going to tell him.

SARAH
You mean how we're going to lie to him?

KADE
Do you want to tell him the truth?
That you're harboring an inter-dimensional refugee?

SARAH
No. But ... I'm not good at lying.

KADE
You won't have to, I'll handle it.

They head back into the farmhouse.

INT. FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sarah paces anxiously. Kade sits at the table.

SARAH
What if he doesn't believe us?

KADE
(shrugs)
Then he doesn't believe us.

SARAH
What if he tells people?

KADE
(smirks)
He could but who would believe him?

Sarah stops pacing, considers this.

SARAH
Fair point.

A car approaches.

Sarah looks out the window.

SARAH (cont'd)
That's him.

KADE
How do you know?

SARAH
I recognize his car.

KADE
You actually know him? Not just
online?

SARAH
(hesitant)
We ... er ... dated. Two years ago.
Before I moved out here.

KADE
Interesting.

SARAH
Confusing.

KADE
And now he's showing up at your farm.

SARAH
Apparently.

They watch as MARCUS gets out of the car.

SARAH (cont'd)
I should talk to him alone first.

KADE
Probably better, I'll wait in the
guest room.

Heads toward the hallway.

A KNOCK on the door.

Sarah takes a deep breath, opens it.

MARCUS (late 20s, concerned expression) stands on the porch.
He looks relieved to see her.

MARCUS
Sarah.

SARAH
Marcus.

An awkward pause.

MARCUS
Can I come in?

SARAH
Yeah. Of course.

INT. FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Marcus enters, looking around, Sarah closes the door.

MARCUS
It's good to see you, you haven't
changed.

SARAH
(shrugs)
Why would I?

MARCUS
I don't know. It's been two years.

Another awkward beat.

MARCUS (cont'd)
Look, your message. The stuff about a
spacecraft and a simulator ... Are
you okay?

SARAH
I'm fine.

MARCUS
Because Phantom and Stardust thought
you were maybe drunk or having some
sort of breakdown.

SARAH
I know how it sounds.

MARCUS
So? Why did you send the message?

SARAH
Because it's true.

Marcus studies her face.

MARCUS
Seriously.

SARAH
Yes, of course, why shouldn't I be
serious.

MARCUS
Sarah, this is not real, spaceships
aren't ...

A SOUND from the hallway as Kade walks in.

KADE
I'm sorry. I should introduce myself.

Marcus immediately tenses, stepping slightly in front of Sarah.

MARCUS
Who the hell is this?

SARAH
Marcus, this is Kade. He's ...

She looks at Kade, unsure how to finish.

KADE
(extending hand)
Commander Kade. Military, we are
working on a classified project.

Marcus doesn't shake the hand.

MARCUS
(sneers)
Classified project, here, on Sarah's
farm.

KADE
That's correct.

MARCUS
(to Sarah)
What's going on?

SARAH
It's complicated.

MARCUS
Try me.

Kade and Sarah exchange a glance.

KADE
The government has developed a new
training simulator. Virtual reality,
next-generation technology. Sarah
mentioned you and your friends are
exceptional at combat flight games.
We're looking for someone to test the
simulator.

MARCUS
Why us?

KADE

To evaluate the simulator's effectiveness with civilian users.

MARCUS

And the spacecraft?

KADE

Part of the simulation. We built a full scale mock-up. Adds to the immersion experience.

Marcus looks at them, clearly skeptical.

MARCUS

This sounds insane.

SARAH

I know.

MARCUS

Why would the military set up a secret simulator on Sarah's farm?

KADE

Isolated location. Low population density. Minimal risk of exposure.

MARCUS

And Sarah just, well, agreed to this?

SARAH

(interjects)

The compensation was good.

Marcus processes this, still suspicious but uncertain.

MARCUS

And why would the others believe me?

KADE

The simulators in the barn.

INT. BARN - DAY

The barn doors open. Marcus steps inside, Sarah and Kade behind him.

He stops dead, staring at Talon-7.

The ship dominates the barn, sleek and beautiful, clearly not from any Earth manufacturer.

MARCUS
(stunned)
What the hell is that?

KADE

The simulator environment. Built to exact specifications of the next-generation fighter craft.

Marcus walks slowly around it, reaching out but not quite touching.

MARCUS
This is... this is... incredible.

SARAH
Yeah, it's pretty impressive.

MARCUS
(inspecting)
The detail, the structure, I've never seen anything like it.

He looks back at Kade.

MARCUS (cont'd)
How much did this cost to build?

KADE
It was expensive, but, that's classified information.

MARCUS
Your telling me.

He continues circling the ship, eyes wide.

MARCUS (cont'd)
Can I see inside?

KADE
Not today, the systems are still being calibrated but if you can convince your friends to participate...

Marcus's attitude has now completely changed, a mixture of awe and shock.

MARCUS
Yeah, yeah, I think I can.

He pulls out his phone, takes a photo of the ship.

KADE
No photos.

MARCUS
What?

KADE
Security protocols.

MARCUS
Then how do I prove to Phantom and
Stardust that this is all real?

SARAH
Tell them you saw it, if they don't
believe you, they can come see for
themselves.

Marcus reluctantly deletes the photo.

MARCUS
They're going to think I'm having
whatever breakdown you're having.

SARAH
Probably.

MARCUS
(to Kade)
What's your actual goal?

KADE
Combat simulation fidelity. Response
time. Tactical decision-making under
pressure. Whether civilian gamers can
match or exceed military pilot
performance.

MARCUS
And if we're good enough?

KADE
(sly smile)
You'll be part of the crew.

MARCUS
Okay. Okay, I'll talk to them.

INT. FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Marcus prepares to leave. Sarah walks him to the door. Kade
hangs back, giving them space.

MARCUS
(quietly)
Are you sure you're okay? With all of
this?

SARAH
I'm fine, really.

MARCUS
Because if you need anything ...

SARAH
I know. Thank you for coming.

MARCUS
Yeah. I'll call Phantom and Stardust
tonight.

He glances back at Kade, then at Sarah.

MARCUS (cont'd)
This is weird, Sarah, really weird.

SARAH
I know.

MARCUS
But that ship... that's the most
amazing thing I've ever seen.

He leaves. Sarah closes the door, leans against it.

Kade approaches.

KADE
So, seems like you already know each
other.

SARAH
It was a long time ago.

KADE
He cares about you.

SARAH
We're just friends now. That's all.

Beat.

KADE
Is he going to try to convince the
others.

SARAH

Maybe.

KADE

And if he succeeds?

SARAH

Then we have a crew.

She moves to the couch, sits heavily.

SARAH (cont'd)

We just lied to him, about everything.

KADE

We gave him a version he could accept.

SARAH

It's still lying.

KADE

Would you prefer to tell him the truth? That in sixteen days, I'm flying back through a wormhole to almost certain death?

SARAH

When do we tell them the truth?

KADE

The day before we leave, if they all agree to help, we tell them everything, then, they can make their decision.

SARAH

And if they don't want to go?

KADE

Then I go alone.

Sarah stares at the floor.

SARAH

I don't like this.

KADE

Neither do I, but we're out of good options.

SARAH

Marcus had an idea, before he left.

KADE
What kind of idea?

SARAH
Use the game to build a replica of
your ship in the game's custom build
module, then, get Phantom and
Stardust to fly it online and see how
it works.

KADE
It might make the real thing less
overwhelming.

SARAH
Exactly.

KADE
Can you do that? Build an accurate
replica in the game?

SARAH
With the AI's help? Probably.

SHIP'S AI
(from nearby)
Affirmative. I can provide exact
specifications, translate them to
game parameters.

SARAH
See? We can start tonight.

KADE
How long until they're ready?

SARAH
In the game? Could be a few days if
they practice seriously.

KADE
And then we bring them here and show
them the real ship.

SARAH
One step at a time.

KADE
Fifteen days left, we need to move
fast.

SARAH
I know.

She walks over to her computer and opens the game.

SARAH (cont'd)
Let's build a spaceship.

INT. FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Sarah sits at her computer. Kade stands behind her, watching. The AI device hovers nearby, its glow illuminating their faces.

On screen: the game's ship building interface. Complex, detailed, with thousands of customization options.

SARAH
Okay. I need dimensions.

SHIP'S AI
Length: forty-seven point three
meters. Width: twenty-one point eight
meters. Height: twelve point four
meters.

Sarah's fingers fly across the keyboard, entering data.

SARAH
Weapon systems?

SHIP'S AI
Four independent operator stations.
Primary armament: dual plasma rail-
guns. Secondary: missile arrays,
sixteen ship-killer class, sixteen
anti-fighter class. Point defense
grid. Electronic warfare suite.

SARAH
The game doesn't have plasma rail-
guns.

SHIP'S AI
Then use the high-velocity energy
weapons with minimal projectile drop.

SARAH
Got it.

She continues working. The ship takes shape on screen—a digital echo of Talon-7.

KADE
How long will this take?

SARAH
An hour, maybe two. Getting it
perfect will take longer.

KADE
Good enough is fine. We need
functional, not perfect.

SARAH
(candidly)
You've never met serious gamers.
They'll notice every detail.

KADE
(smiles)
Then lets build a perfect copy.

INT. FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Sarah leans back, stretching. The completed ship rotates on
screen—nearly identical to Talon-7.

SARAH
Done.

KADE
It looks exactly like the real thing.

SARAH
That's the idea.

She saves the design, uploads it to the game's server.

SARAH (cont'd)
Now I invite them to a private match.
Us versus them. They fly this ship,
we fly standard fighters.

KADE
You want them to fight us?

SARAH
I want them to want this ship. If
they experience how powerful it is,
they'll be hooked.

KADE
And then?

SARAH
Then they practice until they're
good, really good.

KADE
The we show them the real thing.

SARAH
Exactly.

She sends the invitations.

SARAH (cont'd)
Now we wait again.

KADE
I'm starting to hate waiting.

SARAH
Welcome to gaming culture.

A notification PINGS. Sarah's eyes widen.

SARAH (cont'd)
They accepted. Both of them.

KADE
When?

SARAH
(checking)
Tomorrow night. Eight PM.

KADE
Fifteen days left. And we still don't
know if they'll actually come here.

SARAH
One step at a time, remember?

She looks at the ship on screen, then at Kade.

SARAH (cont'd)
This might actually work.

KADE
It has to.

FADE OUT.

TEXT ON SCREEN: "15 DAYS REMAINING"

END OF EPISODE 3